

Drink From the Well of Worship

I can remember at the March conference that sometime just before that, He was introducing me to worship by telling me I did not know much about it. That is how you get a prideful preacher into anything. It is all right to have pride if it only exists before God, because He can kill it.

As He set me on fire with it, I went around with the initial revelation. I would to God that I could pull enough out of you and put enough into you to get you into private worship. I am going to feel like I failed if you leave here and do not break through, because if we cannot get this into you, you are going to miss another major key to the walk of power.

Everything else has everything to do with it: the praying in tongues limb, the speaking the Word limb, the meditation limb. All of it has everything to do with it. The fasting limb is major. But then there is the worship limb. That has a lot to do with the anointing and the tangible presence that surrounds you, something you can feel with your senses.

To tell you the truth, God tried to get me into that kind of worship a couple of years ago. That is why I had a visitation. I knew I could not go one step further and accomplish what He wanted without it. I had that visitation because I had prayed myself to it, praying in tongues and fasting.

Since you are the preacher bunch, I was on the ninth day of a fast when He visited me. He knocked me down on the floor and started talking to me.

Since March, I have not been the same. I would to God that we can get this into you: private worship.

I thank God for all our corporate worship, but it is not enough. It is not enough to bring the change. So I am going to enter in this morning and give you a few verses about the ministry of the Holy Spirit in this limb of worship.

Go to John 16:12. He is pacing me, so that is a safety valve that says I will not be very long. Of course, this afternoon we have until the next morning.

Hallelujah.

Father, I worship You in spirit and truth. I worship You and love You. You are so faithful. You cannot be anything but faithful. Faithfulness is the fruit of one of Your attributes. You cannot be anything else. You are faithful to us unto an end, if You had one. You are utterly faithful. You are always there, doing all You can do, and I am just learning to receive that.

I worship You and praise You and glorify You now. We are hungry for what men cannot give us. So teach us. Teach us. And as Your children, we are very careful to give You all the praise and honor and glory.

Everybody said amen.

John 16:12 says:

I have yet many things to say unto you, but ye cannot bear them now.

The reason they could not bear them was that their candle had not been lit yet. They were unregenerated, spiritually dead men. There was only so much they could understand.

Then Jesus went on to say about the ministry of the Holy Spirit in verse 13:

Howbeit when he, the Spirit of truth, is come, he will guide you into all truth:
for he shall not speak of himself; but whatsoever he shall hear, that shall he speak:
and he will shew you things to come.

Notice verse 14:

He shall glorify me: for he shall receive of mine, and shall shew it unto you.

And verse 15:

All things that the Father hath are mine: therefore said I, that he shall take of mine, and shall shew it unto you.

This is His whole ministry.

Again, as in so many camp meetings before, I cannot thank Him enough for the years I carried the praying in tongues limb around, looking for a tree it would fit on. Baptists did not want it. Faith people did not really want it. Some of them said, "If you pray in tongues too much, you will get weird."

That is a bold-faced lie. I have already done that, and I did not get like you are. If somebody says you pray too much in tongues, they are already weird.

To understand that praying in tongues is a revelation gift, remember that He says, "What I hear, that is what I will speak. I will glorify Jesus." That is the way you activate the Teacher on the inside of you on purpose, as much as you want to, as often as you want to, just because you want to.

When I prayed myself to the place where it was time for the worship limb, guess who also took charge of that revelation of Jesus? I was not in private worship three days before I heard myself, by the inspiration of the Holy Spirit, praying for me in English.

I heard myself saying, "O Lord, Father God, Holy Spirit, is it not Your ministry to turn me over to Jesus? Is it not to glorify Jesus? Holy Spirit, You have to help me die, so that I may glorify Him and He might be exalted. I charge You, Holy Spirit, this is Your ministry. You have to help me to

die. You do not have any choice if Jesus is going to be glorified. You have to help me. Now help me."

Any of you who have crashed into the flesh with worship, those of you who have put it down and won over it, can testify that it is not an easy battle to win. The imaginations multiply. Things you hate about yourself are magnified. Sometimes I came out of six hours of worship feeling like I was a heathen wanting to die.

Hallelujah.

At the end of two weeks I had my first notable baptism of His presence in my senses. It took place right on the line where I fight the battle with the world, where the world tries to influence what I see, hear, and feel, and my new nature tries to promote the Word and say that the world does not have the final say.

The baptism took place on that line, and it was the winning edge for anointings and everything else.

Hallelujah. I captured it. I had to. There are too many preachers waiting for it. I stayed on my face until I captured it. Now I have it.

I have meditated and listened to God for hours, and this is what I captured. I am afraid I cannot do a much better job than to give it to you. If you were going to pray, I would pray, "I catch this and walk away with it."

I do not care how busy your schedule is. I can boldly tell you that you can carve out enough time to start.

Hallelujah.

This is going to have everything to do with the anointing you walk in.

We just had a camp meeting in Phoenix, Arizona, and we had a great time. I was talking to somebody else who was there, and they told me something like seven deaf ears opened, a blind eye opened, a thumb that would not bend was healed, and a man who had scales from chemical burns had something happen to him too.

Definitely, worship has something to do with the tangible presence of God you walk in, that surrounds you and fills your meetings. The more you worship and do the other limbs, the more tangible power will come into your geographical existence.

Are you hearing me?

Hallelujah.

As you know, when I write to somebody, I keep them in front of me so I do not get out of balance.

Brother Tim,

Something unusual happened to me several months ago, and I am just now beginning to understand the effect it is having on my life.

There was a special prayer line to receive the strength for change. In these kinds of lines, it is the grace of God that helps us trade our weaknesses for His strength. When the line was just about over, the Holy Spirit told me to get in. A friend of mine was helping me minister that night. When I got in line, a gentle breeze blew past my ears, and my spirit seemed to get lighter and lighter.

The next thing I knew, I was lying on the floor, and the Holy Spirit was beginning to speak to me. He said, "You do not know much about worship," and went on to instruct me to worship a certain amount of time each day. Not because worship can necessarily be scheduled in and out like an appointment, but so I could initially break through and understand what He wanted to teach me.

Because I was on a certain day of a fast, my mind immediately questioned, "How about fasting? Do You want me to continue fasting?"

God responded, "I did not tell you not to fast. But fasting cannot give you what worship can, and neither can worship give you what fasting does."

Immediately my mind protested a little. God brought me back and reminded me of three revivalists, two of whom I remember would fast two or more forty-day fasts a year. As I looked back over their lives and the effectiveness of their ministries in my mind's eye, God helped me understand that when anyone puts all their confidence in just one key, such as fasting, and believes it is the answer for everything, God will do all He can for them. But unfortunately, there will be other areas of their life He cannot minister to.

As I lay on the floor, I became excited about the prospect of worship the way He was going to teach me. As my mind continued to ponder the different keys He had given me over the years, I could not help but think that if I was guilty of exalting one key as the answer to everything, it would be praying in tongues.

But God comforted me by assuring me that because praying in tongues is a revelation gift, it is something you cannot do too much of. It is the reason He was able to reveal so many other keys that I now understand and hold so close to my heart, such as meditation, confession, fasting, and now worship.

So when He said to me, "You do not know much about worship," I made the necessary arrangements to set myself aside a certain amount of time each day to worship and find out what He wanted me to know.

I went into my sound room where I make radio tapes, closed the door, and began to worship.

Two weeks later I was experiencing a presence that, up until that time, I only knew existed in the realm of possibility. Now I was experiencing firsthand what has got to be what so many of us are looking for but do not quite know what it is, having never experienced drinking from the deep well of worship.

So follow me closely, Tim. This could be what you are looking for. It could change your faith forever and change the way you receive from God.

As many times as I have been over the Word of God, it continues to amaze me how much of it I still miss. In those times when you think you know everything about a verse, it happens again. Something opens up that changes the way you look at things.

This is what happened to me with the Scriptures concerning the Samaritan woman, when Jesus sat down on the edge of Jacob's well and began to reveal His heart and the heart of His Father to her in John 4.

It changed the way I looked at worship forever.

As I listened to my spirit and went over and over the encounter He had with her, it was there at Jacob's well that I began to understand what my Father wanted from me: the closeness you can only have with family.

God is first my Father, and then He is my God. As my God, He has given me everlasting life and secured my future with an abundance as inexhaustible as the limitless power He holds as Creator. But as my Father, He wants from us the fellowship and closeness we can only give Him through being born again and climbing up into His arms with a nature like His own, loving Him with the adoration and worship of a son who believes the sun rises and sets on his father and that there is none other like him.

As Jesus sat on the edge of Jacob's well and talked with the Samaritan woman, I knew He was separating the kind of worship we can have with God the Father from the kind the Old Testament saints could have with Him. They could not give Him what they did not have, and that is the worship that comes from the new nature of the born-again human spirit.

For God is a Spirit, and those who worship Him must worship Him in spirit and in truth.

When Jesus said in John 4:23:

But the hour cometh, and now is, when the true worshippers shall worship the Father in spirit and in truth: for the Father seeketh such to worship him,

He meant there had never been an hour before this one. Not in the history of man could anyone ever worship God in spirit and in truth. Not since the fall of Adam and the spiritual death of the human race could anyone give Him what He wanted from them: the fellowship and worship that emanates from the new nature.

But you can, because you have been born again.

When He said, "For the Father seeketh such to worship him," it did not mean He was hopping from church to church looking for a good worship team. It means God sought and waited out the generations leading up to the cross, patiently working the redemption plan, longing for the day

when He could restore the new nature to the human race and have the kind of fellowship with them He had been waiting for four thousand years. That was made available only through the new birth.

And I can give Him what He wants.

It is not that God did not have a relationship with the Old Testament saints. He did. They worshiped Him out of their mind and soul and gave Him as much of themselves as they could.

But as much as God loved them, there was only a certain closeness He could have with them because of their sin natures. Even that closeness could only be obtained through animal sacrifice as they worshiped Him through the veil of animal blood.

What God longed for, they could not give: the fellowship and worship that comes from being born again and having the same nature as He does.

Hebrews 10:4 says:

For it is not possible that the blood of bulls and of goats should take away sins.

Jesus could not have spoken more highly of anyone under the Old Covenant than He did of John the Baptist when He said in Matthew 11:11:

Verily I say unto you, Among them that are born of women there hath not risen a greater than John the Baptist:

notwithstanding he that is least in the kingdom of heaven is greater than he.

Of all the Old Testament saints, the prophets, the men of wisdom such as Moses, David, and King Solomon, Jesus said there had never been one born of woman greater than John. But He went on to say that he who is least in the kingdom is greater than John.

Why? Because before Jesus rose from the dead, the new nature was not yet available. The least in the kingdom of heaven would be greater than John because the Old Testament saints had not yet been given the new birth.

How could Jesus say the least in the kingdom of heaven was greater than John if John already belonged to the kingdom of heaven? He did not, because the new nature was not yet available. John, like Nicodemus, had not yet been born again.

You have. Oh, but you have.

John could not give the Father what He longed for: the fellowship of the new nature. Nor could King Solomon or King David. Their fellowship with God pulled up just short of the unregenerated human spirit. God could not go there.

But we can, Tim. We have been born again.

All the Old Testament saints lived under the shadow of things to come. One thing is sure: there cannot be a shadow without something present to make the shadow. Once a person is born again, they no longer belong to the shadow. They have been baptized into whatever is making the shadow, and that is the Body of Christ.

When the Judaizers came to the Colossians trying to indoctrinate them into keeping the law, Paul said in Colossians 2:16-17:

Let no man therefore judge you in meat, or in drink, or in respect of an holyday, or of the new moon, or of the sabbath days:

Which are a shadow of things to come; but the body is of Christ.

I frequently run into believers who keep the Sabbath, not understanding that the Sabbath was a type and shadow of something else to come. Once He who is making the shadow has come, it is impossible to live in the shadow and in the thing making the shadow at the same time.

Have you wondered why, under the shadow of the law, if a man even picked up a stick of firewood on the Sabbath day, he would be stoned to death?

Numbers 15:32-36 says:

And while the children of Israel were in the wilderness, they found a man that gathered sticks upon the sabbath day.

And they that found him gathering sticks brought him unto Moses and Aaron, and unto all the congregation.

And they put him in ward, because it was not declared what should be done to him.

And the Lord said unto Moses, The man shall be surely put to death: all the congregation shall stone him with stones without the camp.

And all the congregation brought him without the camp, and stoned him with stones, and he died; as the Lord commanded Moses.

Under the shadow, the Sabbath was a type of the rest you and I would enter when we were born again and ceased from the burden and weight of our own sins.

When Joshua led the children of Israel across Jordan into the promised land, if he had been able to give them rest, then Paul would not have said what he did in Hebrews 4:8-10 about another day:

For if Jesus had given them rest, then would he not afterward have spoken of another day.

There remaineth therefore a rest to the people of God.

For he that is entered into his rest, he also hath ceased from his own works, as God did from his.

Because the Sabbath is a type of the rest you and I enter when we are born again, the penalty was so stringent for even picking up a piece of firewood because our salvation cannot be earned. Any work whatsoever on the Sabbath under the shadow took salvation out of grace and put it into works, under which it would be impossible to be born again.

That is what Paul said in Ephesians 2:8-9:

For by grace are ye saved through faith; and that not of yourselves: it is the gift of God:
Not of works, lest any man should boast.

Men like John the Baptist, King David, and King Solomon waited out the generations leading up to the cross in an Old Testament type of heaven, which was the shadow of heaven itself.

It was a very comfortable place that Jesus talked about in Luke 16:22:

And it came to pass, that the beggar died, and was carried by the angels into Abraham's bosom.

Later Jesus said Lazarus was comforted in this place of the shadow of heaven. Some of them waited thousands of years. Before the flood there was a place that anticipated Abraham's bosom, and Abraham's bosom was the promise and shadow of our final deliverance into heaven itself. But that had to wait on the rebirth.

Hallelujah.

Jesus said Lazarus was comforted there. I mean, they talked and had tea parties and everything. It was wonderful.

So, Tim, it was very comfortable waiting out the dispensations leading up to the cross underneath the shadow until Jesus could give them all a new nature and bring them out from underneath the shadow into heaven itself, forever in the presence of God.

All creation waited for the firstborn from the dead to be born, which was Jesus Christ. We know there were several resurrections under the Old Testament before Jesus' time, so if Colossians was talking about natural resurrection and not spiritual resurrection, any one of those could have been first because they all went before Jesus.

The emphasis was not on Jesus' natural resurrection, but on His spiritual one. How could He be called the firstborn from the dead if there had been anyone before Him? There was not, not even Adam. After the spiritual death of the human race, all had to wait for the firstborn to be born so they might follow Him out of spiritual death.

Colossians 1:18 says:

And he is the head of the body, the church:
who is the beginning, the firstborn from the dead;
that in all things he might have the preeminence.

Hallelujah.

When He said to me, "You do not know much about worship," what He wanted me to understand was the difference between Old and New Testament worship. Out of our new nature there is a communion through worship that flows from our spirit to God's Spirit that is sin-free. God is a Spirit, and He seeks such to worship Him and longs for this kind of fellowship with His children.

You might as well know that your personal worship in heaven will be spontaneous. Surrounded by the glories of heaven, you will not be able to contain yourself.

Multiply hundreds of thousands of times the same feelings you have here when you love someone so much that you want to bring them joy, and your greatest joy is to bring them happiness. When the Father smiles at you in heaven, Tim, you will feel like you have found your greatest purpose in life.

Floods of joy will make you certain that you are the highest achiever who has ever lived, and that to please Him is the most fulfilling thing you have ever done. Those deep-seated feelings of joy will erupt frequently in worship as the Father's joy sweeps over us in waves, and we know we have found everything, with eternity ahead of us and the knowledge that none of this is ever going to end. It will just get better.

And just think, Tim, we do not have to wait until we get to heaven. The Father lives in great expectation that you will begin to fellowship with Him now.

Who cannot worship Him in heaven? Who cannot, when it is spontaneous and the waves of glory cause you to erupt into worship on the spot? Who can help it? It brings Him such joy that it is absolutely incredible.

You can bring Him the same thing now. There is no distance between us and Him. What separates us could not be measured by standards of distance, but by spiritual death. Now we have been put back into His presence and can worship Him and fellowship with Him as though we were in heaven itself, made possible through your new nature.

God tried to get me into extended worship a year and a half before this time. I only wish I had listened. Had I known what worship would do to my faith, much less to my ability to receive from God, I would have surrendered long ago to even the smallest prompting. It would not have taken the light rebuke I received in the prayer line that night.

Here is what I am saying, Tim: take it from an old warhorse who has been around for a while. This could be what you are looking for.

I was on my way back from a passion play when He first tried to get me into this. Everything was perfect: the costumes, the acting, the music, everything. Nothing was out of place. Not one note of music, not one prop. Hell was hot. Angels flew.

There was just one problem: no anointing.

While I was riding along wondering why, and what it would take to fill a passion play like that with God's presence, God took advantage of the situation to teach me.

I had one of those visions that materializes in your spirit, yet is worth the understanding of a thousand words. It was a small rock landing in a pond, and the ripples that emanated from the stone filled the whole pond.

He said to me, "The more you worship, the more the Holy Spirit will be able to permeate your spirit with presence. The ripples from your spirit will permeate your soul, and the ripples from your soul will permeate your senses until His presence not only surrounds your whole being, but will permeate the atmosphere around you until even other people are aware of His presence."

Can you imagine what this could do to a worship leader's anointing, or to the message of a preacher, or to the home of a believer, much less to the unbelief that fights all of us? Your emotions could just as easily be charged with His presence as with torment and fear.

Your call.

When I locked myself up in my sound room, I had no motive other than to worship God. I was not asking for anything. I was not trying to receive anything. So I was not entirely prepared for what was about to happen.

At first it was easy. Then the time I had committed to worship began to stretch itself out until even minutes took their time passing by. At times I felt as dry as cracker juice, my flesh as cold as a side of beef in a meat locker, but I kept going.

Then it began to happen.

Please listen to me. Never listen to teachings that say because you do not feel His presence when you are worshiping, He is not there, He is not coming, or you are doing something wrong. That dry process you go through is nothing more than the change you are going through.

What makes you think that just because you do not feel Him, He is not receiving the worship? Do not listen to that kind of teaching. Whether you broke through has nothing to do with whether you felt like you broke through. In fact, some of the times when you feel it least, you are breaking through most, because you are dealing with the things that kept you from it before.

God is looking for a few good men and women.

Hallelujah.

At first it was easy. Then the time I had committed to worship began to stretch out until even minutes took their time passing by. At times I felt as dry as cracker juice, my flesh as cold as a side of beef in a meat locker, but I kept going.

I love You. I love You. Hallelujah. I said I love You. I mean, I really love You.

Hallelujah.

Some kind of baptism of my senses began to take place as His presence came and lingered with me as I went about my day. This presence seemed to want to fellowship with my decisions and with my prayers as I prayed for people. He was there before I was. It seemed to want to fill my faith with the presence that has to be the substance of the things hoped for.

Long-standing answers to prayer began to come in. Hebrews 11:1 says:

Now faith is the substance of things hoped for, the evidence of things not seen.

I should have known worship had something to do with receiving from God. God put me into extended amounts of time to teach me because I am a teacher and He knew I would do it. But to teach you in this letter what He has for you concerning worship would be impossible. It would have to be a book.

You and I are going to explore incredible things in God. Right now I can tell you that even short amounts of time giving yourself completely to worship, maybe a half hour to an hour each day, will be enough to start everything.

Short times where you offer your whole self, pouring everything you are into short statements of adoration, magnifying and glorifying Him, giving Him all the praise and honor and glory. Tim, He loves it when you continually say things like, "I love You, Father God. I love You. I adore You. I want You more than life."

He loves it, Tim. You have enough faith to do this, and you are going to be surprised what God will do for you. It is not how good you make statements about God sound as you try to structure worship into great theological speeches. It is the amount of heart and soul you pour into each statement of adoration.

Tim, look at Ephesians 5:17-20:

Wherefore be ye not unwise, but understanding what the will of the Lord is.

And be not drunk with wine, wherein is excess; but be filled with the Spirit;

Speaking to yourselves in psalms and hymns and spiritual songs, singing and making melody in your heart to the Lord;

Giving thanks always for all things unto God and the Father in the name of our Lord Jesus Christ.

Notice that when he said, "speaking to yourselves," he was talking about private worship.

When I went before God to worship Him, I had no motive other than to love Him and give Him glory. But, Tim, you cannot go before God to worship Him without it having a profound effect on your senses. I have come to call this the baptism of my senses in His presence.

When verse 18 says, "Be not drunk with wine, wherein is excess; but be filled with the Spirit," what part of a person is affected by too much alcohol? Isn't it the senses? Yet somehow Paul compared that to being filled with the Spirit.

Why does an alcoholic drink? Some of them never sober up. In fact, if you saw them sober, you would not know them. They do it to cope with life's problems. They sedate their senses with alcohol so the reality of those problems and of life never has to settle in.

But not us, Tim. We belong to a spiritual kingdom, yet God had to leave us in a physical body with our senses continually in contact with a negative world we have to deal with every day.

The same way an alcoholic deals with life by numbing his senses to it, you and I can be filled with the Spirit by speaking to ourselves, which is private worship, in psalms, hymns, and spiritual songs. Worship will have a similar effect on your senses as alcohol has on the alcoholic's senses. Only he is running from his responsibilities, and you are running toward yours.

The presence of alcohol moving upon his mind moves him out of responsibility and into irresponsibility. But the presence of the Holy Spirit moving upon our mind moves us out of the world of irresponsibility and into responsibility. The presence of God moving upon your senses sedates you against the negative input of the world that is against the promises of God. It manifests itself in presence and peace that says, "The operation of God's kingdom is more real and alive to me than the operation of this world."

Let's cancel this afternoon and worship God.

In my time of private worship, I do not only spend time telling my Father how much I love Him, not asking for anything, just loving Him. I also spend time thanking Him and praising Him for all He has done for me and provided.

As Ephesians 5:20 says:

Giving thanks always for all things unto God and the Father in the name of our Lord Jesus Christ.

Remember, Jesus will become to you what you call Him the most. You cannot worship God for an hour and call Jesus your Healer, Provider, Peace, or Wisdom without Him becoming to you those things you call Him.

It has been my pleasure.

Your friend.

Oh, glory to God. Hallelujah. Hallelujah, Jesus.

I thank God for our team, our staff, and our people here, because anything spiritual that I want to do, they are right there and they will move everything. It is all moved. If I fail in this life and ministry, it will not be because I did not have every opportunity to succeed.

It was not always like that. I used to put in ten to twelve hours first, then pick people up, then drive two hours, go to the meeting, fellowship until two in the morning because a preacher wanted to talk to me, go home, and repeat the same thing the next day as long as the revival ran.

It was not always like this.

The day all my time was my own, I thought I had died and gone to heaven, because I was getting to do what I would have killed to do.

I can remember the first three months I got seven hundred dollars in debt. Today that would have been about three thousand. I made a stand in faith and prayed in tongues every day for three months. One day a man walked up to me and handed me enough money to pay all my bills, give a hundred away, and still have a hundred left over.

The day I got the check, the next day the bank opened, I went in and said, "When I put this in, can I just write checks on it?" We always cashed our check from the mill.

He said, "Yes, you can write checks on it."

I went down and paid the food bill for what we had charged. When I was walking down the street, the sun was brighter and the birds sang. Butterflies flew around my head.

When I got done paying everything, I went back to my closet where I had been praying in tongues, not knowing what it would do. I got down, looked at the money I had left over, and started worshipping God.

I said, "Now wait a minute. I get to get out of bad things, and all day long I get to do what I would have killed to do. I get to meditate and pray, then go out and tell other people what You told me, and You are going to pay me for it? What is this, heaven?"

But preachers give up so easily.

God is not going to give you that time when you are throwing away the time you have now. You are talking full time, you lazy thing, and you are fooling yourself. When you are serving in full capacity with your job, that is when He will send you.

You think you can sit around and cry about your needs not being met because you are called full time? Get the hint. Nobody wants you. You ran out of meetings. Your day will come.

I not only built the furniture for the little Sunday school classes, I taught them. I not only taught them, I picked them up. We would run our red station wagon thirty miles away to La Pine, pick up a group of them there, and run them all over. If the church needed cleaned, I was there to clean,

there to paint, there to do everything.

Now He has given me my time, all that I want. You do not have to have the time I did. Listen to me. Be convinced. Take it from somebody who has already been there.

Be the sower that overtakes the harvester. Make dust. Let me see you in dust. Come on. Do in seven years what I did in twenty-six. Make dust. Make me happy.

Let's stand up and worship God for a minute.